

FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA

Phase 1 · Film #6

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	6 of 29
Phase	Phase 1
Real title	<i>CAPTAIN AMERICA</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"VICTORY GARDEN"</i>
Release date	Friday, July 22, 2011
Distributor	Paramount Pictures
Director	Joe Johnston
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 156 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + WWII war epic (the MCU's only period piece)

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	TYRESE AVERY. The Captain America franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Tyrese Avery	29 (<i>plays 20 → 24; black don't crack</i>)
James "Bucky" Barnes	Sebastian Stan	28
Johann Schmidt / The Red Skull	Hugo Weaving	51
Dr. Abraham Erskine	Stanley Tucci	50
Peggy Carter	Hayley Atwell	29
Gen. Chester Phillips	Tommy Lee Jones	64
Sgt. Nick Fury	Samuel L. Jackson (<i>digitally de-aged for WWII</i>)	62
Cpl. Timothy "Dum Dum" Dugan	Neal McDonough	45
Pvt. Gabe Jones	Derek Luke	37
Baron Heinrich Zemo	Christoph Waltz (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	54
Namor the Sub-Mariner (<i>Invaders cameo</i>)	Tenoch Huerta	30
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a general at the medal ceremony</i>)	Stan Lee	88

Accuracy flag: on 616, Bucky is a teenager in 1941. Sebastian Stan (28) is the only real actor to have played him, so per the Casting Rules he keeps the role. Bucky is written as the oldest-looking 17-year-old in the Army, which is also how Ed Brubaker's modern 616 version frames him.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Captain America Comics</i> #1 (March 1941), Joe Simon & Jack Kirby: Project: Rebirth, Dr. Erskine's assassination, Bucky, the Red Skull. <i>The Avengers</i> #4 (March 1964), Lee & Kirby: Zemo's drone plane , Bucky's "death," and Cap frozen in the ice.
Supporting comics	<i>Captain America Comics</i> #2 (1941, the round shield) · <i>Captain America</i> #303 (1985, Dr. Myron MacLain and the shield's accidental alloy) · <i>Sgt. Fury and His Howling Commandos</i> #13 (1964): Cap and Bucky fight beside Fury's Howlers · <i>The Avengers</i> #6 (1964, Zemo's Adhesive X) · <i>The Invaders</i> (1975, Roy Thomas): Namor and the original Human Torch · Ed Brubaker's <i>Captain America</i> (2005 on): the modern version of Bucky
Nerf check	✓ Cap is the peak of human potential , the best hand-to-hand fighter and battlefield tactician alive. His shield is indestructible .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97% . The Golden Age origin is almost exact, joined to the <i>Avengers</i> #4 flashback of how Cap was lost.

Straight from the page:

- **Frail Steve Rogers** is rejected by the Army. **Dr. Abraham Erskine** chooses him for **Project: Rebirth**. He's given the **super-soldier serum** and bathed in **Vita-Rays**, and he becomes the **perfect human**.
- A **Nazi spy (Heinz Kruger)** assassinates Erskine straight afterward, and the formula dies with him. **Steve is the only one**.
- At **Camp Lehigh, Virginia**, Steve poses as a **clumsy private**. The camp mascot, **Bucky Barnes**, walks in on him changing into costume and becomes his partner.
- **The first shield is the triangular one** (*CA Comics* #1), and it's later replaced by **the round shield**, a gift from **President Roosevelt** (*CA Comics* #2), made from an alloy **Dr. Myron MacLain** created by accident and could never reproduce.
- **The Red Skull**, Johann Schmidt, is Hitler's right hand. **In WWII he wears a red skull MASK** (Golden Age), so this Skull is a man in a mask. He uses the **Dust of Death**.
- **Cap and Bucky fight beside Sgt. Nick Fury's Howling Commandos** (*Sgt. Fury* #13).
- **The Invaders**: Namor and the android Human Torch appear in a battle montage.
- **April 1945**: Cap and Bucky try to stop **Baron Zemo's** explosive-rigged **drone plane**. Bucky is still on it when it blows up. **Cap falls into the icy North Atlantic** and freezes in suspended animation (*Avengers* #4).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Red Skull and Zemo both appear in one film | Runtime. They're Cap's two great WWII enemies, and both

come straight from the comics. |

| The Invaders are a montage cameo | They're held for a future WWII-era project. Their existence is set up. |

| Steve's age: b. **July 4, 1920** (616) | 616 accurate. Tyrese plays 20–24. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Captain America	The super-soldier serum: peak-human strength (lifts more than 1,000 lbs overhead), speed, agility, endurance, reflexes and healing at the very limit of human potential; he doesn't tire the way ordinary men do; master martial artist; tactical genius; master of the shield (ricochet throws) (<i>CA Comics</i> #1 on)	All of it: outruns a car, throws the shield in a triple ricochet that takes out three machine-gun nests, carries a wounded Howler five miles through snow, fights twelve Nazi soldiers in a train car	–	✓ 100%
The shield	Indestructible round shield of an accidental alloy; perfectly balanced for ricochet throws; absorbs impacts	Stops a tank round point-blank; ricochet throws	–	✓ 100%
Bucky Barnes	Expert marksman; trained hand-to-hand fighter; commando	Sniper cover; knife fights	His future as the Winter Soldier (616, 2005). Seeded, not shown.	✓ 100%
The Red Skull	No superpowers in WWII (616); master strategist , expert fighter; the Dust of Death (a toxin that shrivels its victims' heads into red skulls)	The Dust of Death kills a traitor, and he holds his own with Cap in hand-to-hand for a round	His later cloned body with serum (616, later)	✓ 100% (the Golden Age Skull is human)
Baron Zemo	Genius scientist; expert swordsman; Adhesive X ; death-ray weapons (<i>Avengers</i> #4, #6)	Adhesive X (and the hood glued to his face), the drone plane, a sword duel with Cap	–	✓ 100%
Nick Fury	Master soldier, tactician and leader; the Infinity Formula (injected after the war on 616, so not shown here)	Leads the Howling Commandos	The Infinity Formula (backstory for later)	✓ 100%
Namor	Mutant Atlantean prince: superhuman strength, flight (ankle wings), amphibious	Leaps out of the sea and tears apart a U-boat	His full story (Phase 2)	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A frail young man from the Lower East Side becomes the only super-soldier in history. He leads America's fight against the Red Skull and gives everything, including the next sixty-seven years, to win the war.
Theme	Courage belongs to the heart, not the body. Steve was a hero before the serum. The serum just caught up.
Villain / antagonist	The Red Skull (main); Baron Heinrich Zemo (the finale)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: REBIRTH

- **New York, Monday, December 9, 1940.** **Steve Rogers**, 20, skinny and sick, is rejected for the fourth time. He doesn't give up.
- **Dr. Abraham Erskine** watches him throw himself on a dummy grenade in a training yard and chooses him.
- **Tuesday, March 4, 1941, Project: Rebirth.** The serum and the Vita-Rays turn Steve into **the perfect human**.
- Seconds later a Nazi spy **shoots Erskine dead**. Steve runs him down on foot, but the formula is gone. **There will only be one.**

ACT TWO: THE SENTINEL OF LIBERTY

- Steve is secretly stationed at **Camp Lehigh, Virginia**, posing as a clumsy private. The camp mascot, **Bucky Barnes**, catches him changing into his costume, and they become partners.
- The **triangular shield**, and then the **round one**, which **President Roosevelt** gives him in the Oval Office.
- **Pearl Harbor**. Cap and Bucky go to war.
- They team up with **Sgt. Nick Fury's Howling Commandos**, who include Dugan, Gabe Jones and the rest of the 616 Howlers, and they run operations across occupied Europe with **Peggy Carter** of the French Resistance.
- The **Invaders** battle montage: Namor bursts out of the Channel, and a flaming android flies overhead.
- **The Red Skull**. Hitler's terror operative, masked, uses the Dust of Death on his own officers and plans the ruin of the Allies.

ACT THREE: THE ICE

- **Normandy, June 6, 1944** (Fury's line from Chapter One). Cap duels the Red Skull in a collapsing bunker. The Skull is caught by his own Dust of Death and **disappears**.
- **Baron Zemo** builds a **drone plane loaded with explosives** aimed at London.
- **Wednesday, April 25, 1945, over the North Atlantic.** Cap and Bucky catch the drone at takeoff. Cap is thrown clear. **Bucky stays on board, trying to disarm it**, and the plane **explodes**.
- Cap falls into the black water and the ice closes over him.
- The last image is **the shield sinking into the dark**.

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, December 9, 1940 → Wednesday, April 25, 1945 . Both post-credit scenes take place in 2011 (see below).
Where it's set	New York (the Lower East Side, Brooklyn) · Camp Lehigh, Virginia · Washington, D.C. (the Oval Office) · Occupied France and Germany · Normandy · the North Atlantic (filmed on location in England, the Czech Republic and Iceland)
Relative to other films	The earliest events in the MCU . In the present day, the post-credit scenes are set in mid-2011 (around June), fourteen months after <i>Iron Man 2</i> .

Steve Rogers timeline (canon):

Event	Date
Born, Lower East Side	July 4, 1920
Project: Rebirth	March 4, 1941
Frozen	April 25, 1945 (age 24)
Found	*The Avengers* (2012)

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **WWII in the MCU**: Project: Rebirth, **the only super-soldier**, the Howling Commandos, the Invaders.
- **The shield**, and the alloy nobody can reproduce.
- **The Red Skull** and **Zemo**, Cap's permanent enemies.
- **Peggy Carter** and **Bucky**, the two people Steve loses.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Nick Fury's history	Sgt. Fury and the Howlers on screen. This is where Samuel L. Jackson's Fury comes from .	Every later film
Why Fury has been searching	Fury saw Cap fall	The <i>Iron Man 2</i> post-credit scene, and <i>The Avengers</i>
The Invaders: Namor	The Channel montage	<i>The Avengers</i>: Namor is the one who finds Cap in the ice (<i>Avengers</i> #4)
The Winter Soldier	See the Big Bad setup below	Phase 2
The Red Skull lives	The mid-credit scene	Phase 2

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Death turns away	As the drone plane explodes, only the audience sees the hooded woman standing on the ice floe, looking toward Bucky. Then she turns away , as if there's nothing there for her.	Bucky isn't dead. The Winter Soldier is coming, and Death doesn't take what isn't hers.
The Cosmic Cube	The post-credit scene	The first thing Thanos went after on 616 , before the Gems (<i>Captain Marvel</i> #27–33).

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "SLEEPER." Present day, 2011. A sealed Nazi bunker in the Bavarian Alps, found by a hiking party. A flashlight moves over a stasis chamber filled with red gas. Inside, a man in a red skull mask is still breathing, very slowly.
Post-credit scene	✓ "THE CUBE." Present day, 2011. A sterile lab. Scientists in yellow beekeeper-style suits, A.I.M. (Advanced Idea Mechanics), watch a small, glowing cube hover in a containment field. A.I.M. SCIENTIST: "<i>Stable. It's stable. Anything we imagine...</i>" The cube flashes. For a split second, every screen in the lab shows the same image: a golden helmet and a purple face. Then it's gone. CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN IN <i>THE AVENGERS</i>."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " FIELD TRIP. " Post-credit: " BEE KEEPING. "

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Comic(s) adapted · ☐ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☐ Real and decoy titles · ☐ What it's about · ☐ Villain · ☐ Post-credit scenes · ☐ The film's own world-building · ☐ MCU world-building · ☐ Big Bad setup · ☐ Whose franchise · ☐ When and where in the timeline